Process Definition Document (PDD)

Project 5: Purchase Order Management System

Purpose: Define the business process for tracking SAP purchase order status and automating the capture and distribution of PO updates. The process includes real-time status sharing where supported, screenshot capture for agreed evidence or diagnostics, and resilient handling of SAP timeout scenarios.

1. Business Background

Procurement teams and business stakeholders need reliable, timely visibility into purchase order status. Manual checks and follow-up messages can delay updates and create avoidable dependency on procurement users. The proposed RPA workflow retrieves PO status from SAP, validates and organizes the information, and shares it with approved stakeholders. The stated project outcome is a 40% reduction in follow-up dependency through real-time PO status sharing; this result should be measured against an agreed baseline.

2. Objectives

- Standardize PO status tracking requirements across the in-scope process.
- Automate capture of approved SAP PO status updates.
- Share current status information with approved stakeholders in a timely manner.
- Reduce manual follow-ups, with a target of 40% reduction subject to measurement.
- Handle SAP timeouts and retrieval errors without silently losing records.
- Capture screenshots only where approved for process evidence or troubleshooting.

3. Scope

In scope

- Read-only retrieval of purchase order status from the approved SAP environment.
- Processing agreed PO numbers, company codes, purchasing groups or date ranges.
- Capture of required PO details and current status values.
- Validation, duplicate handling and optional comparison with prior status records.
- Screenshot capture for approved exception evidence or troubleshooting, subject to security policy.
- Generation and distribution of status reports or notifications.
- Run logging, timeout recovery, exception reporting and delivery-status tracking.

Out of scope

- Creating, approving, editing or cancelling purchase orders.
- Changing SAP master data or supplier records.
- Making procurement decisions or interpreting commercial terms.
- Capturing screenshots of sensitive information beyond what is necessary and authorized.
- Sending PO data to recipients who are not approved for that information.

4. Stakeholders and Responsibilities

Stakeholder	Responsibility
Procurement process owner	Defines PO selection rules, status meanings, report

	requirements and acceptance criteria.
Procurement users	Review PO outputs and resolve business exceptions.
Business stakeholders	Confirm the status information required and approved delivery channel.
RPA developer	Builds, tests, documents and maintains the A360 automation.
SAP / IT support	Supports SAP access, availability and application-related failures.
Information security	Approves access permissions, screenshot handling, storage and distribution controls.

5. Inputs and Outputs

Category	Details
Inputs	Approved SAP environment, PO selection criteria, required fields, schedule and recipient list.
Captured fields	PO number, item number if required, supplier ID/name where authorized, company code, status, PO date and last update where available.
Outputs	Current PO status report, changed-status notification if required, exception list, execution log and approved diagnostic evidence.
Delivery	Approved email group, shared folder or procurement reporting location.

6. High-Level Process Flow

1. Start the bot on the agreed schedule or approved manual trigger.
2. Load configuration, PO selection criteria, output location and recipient list.
3. Validate the required configuration before connecting to SAP.
4. Log in to SAP using the approved authentication method and authorized account.
5. Search for the relevant POs and retrieve the approved status fields.
6. Confirm the search or report completed before interpreting the results.
7. Validate required fields and normalize the output format.
8. Compare with prior successful data if change-only notifications are in scope.
9. Capture a screenshot only for approved evidence or a relevant exception, following security rules.
10. Prepare the report, status notifications and exception list.
11. Distribute approved outputs, record delivery results and close the SAP session.

7. Business Rules

- Only approved SAP records and selection criteria may be processed.
- SAP status values must be reported as displayed or mapped using a business-approved mapping table.
- The bot must not guess missing PO fields or infer a status when SAP does not provide one.
- An empty search result is valid only when the SAP search completed successfully and explicitly returned no records.
- A timeout or failed query must be recorded as a failed check, not as 'no PO updates'.
- Screenshot evidence must be limited to the relevant screen or error and stored only in an approved location.
- Sensitive credentials, tokens and unnecessary supplier or financial data must not appear in screenshots or logs.
- Only validated outputs may be distributed to authorized recipients.
- The bot must not perform PO creation, approval, modification or cancellation.

8. Timeout and Exception Handling

Scenario	Expected handling
SAP response timeout	Wait using the approved timeout, retry within the configured limit, then log the failed check and notify support if unresolved.
Login or authorization failure	Stop protected actions, record a sanitized error and alert SAP/IT support.
PO not found	Record the result according to the approved rule and include it in exceptions if the PO was expected.
Missing or unknown status	Flag for procurement review; do not substitute an assumed status.
Unexpected SAP screen	Stop the affected transaction, record safe diagnostic details and capture a screenshot only if policy permits.
Duplicate record	Apply the approved key, such as PO number plus item number when needed.
Report delivery failure	Keep the report in the approved secure location and alert support.
Partial run	Continue with other records when safe and clearly identify failed or unprocessed items.

9. Assumptions and Dependencies

- Procurement will provide final PO criteria, field definitions, status mapping and recipients.
- The bot account will have only the SAP permissions required for read-only retrieval.
- Screenshot capture and retention will be approved by security and data-handling policies.
- The 40% reduction target will be measured using a defined baseline and consistent measurement method.
- SAP layout, performance or access changes may require bot maintenance.

10. Acceptance Criteria

- The bot retrieves correct PO statuses for approved test records.
- Timeouts and failed searches are clearly distinguished from successful searches with no results.
- Missing fields, unknown statuses and failed retrievals are recorded in the exception output.
- Screenshots, where enabled, follow the approved security and retention rules.
- Reports are shared only with approved recipients and delivery outcomes are logged.
- The workflow does not create or modify SAP purchase orders.
- The 40% reduction in follow-up dependency is evaluated using agreed before-and-after measurements.

11. Items to Confirm Before Sign-off

- SAP access method, transaction/report and PO selection criteria.
- Required fields and status-change definition.
- Meaning of 'real-time' for this process: event-driven, frequent scheduled polling or on-demand retrieval.
- Screenshot trigger conditions, storage location, access permissions and retention period.
- Retry count, timeout values, alert route and manual fallback procedure.
- Distribution channel, report format and approved recipients.
- Baseline and method for measuring the stated 40% reduction.